



Solving crosswords with Linux

While solving crosswords, a few letters of a word are usually given, based on which we try to guess the remaining letters. Now, this guessing can be done easily with Linux, using shell script.

To create the required shell script, use the following commands and name it 'crossie':

```
balki@glug-t:~$ vi crossie
```

Type the following:

```
exp='echo "^\${1}$" | tr ' ' ' ';
```

```
grep "$exp" < /usr/share/dict/words
```

Save and exit the editor and search for words like:

```
balki@glug-t:~$ sh crossie c-mp-te-
```

You will see the following output:

```
competed
competer
competes
compotes
computed
computer
computes
```

```
balki@glug-t:~$ crossie e-c--o--d-a
```

```
encyclopedia
```

```
balki@glug-t:~$
```

—Balakrishnan B, balakrishnan.erode@gmail.com



Use of apropos

If you do not know where to get started and which man page to read for a particular command, *apropos* is something that can help you with more information. For example, if you do not know how to start a browser, then enter the following command:

```
#apropos browser
```

After pressing *Enter* you will see a lot of browser related data as the output. This will include details about not only Web browsers, but also file and FTP browsers.

—Nebu Pulickal, nebupulickal@gmail.com



Pre-processed output

GCC works in four stages, namely, pre-processing, compiling, assembling and linking. We can stop and see the output of GCC at any stage, for which there is one lesser known option. If we want only Macros to be replaced and then want to see the source code, use an option named '-E option' by typing the command stated below... and see the magic!

```
#gcc -E test.c > test1
```

```
#vim test1
```

—Viral Mehta, viral.vkm@gmail.com



Starting VI with the search pattern

There is an option available in VI editor to open a file with a search pattern.

If, for instance, a file named 'xyz.c' has a 'printf' string and you want to search the same, you can open the file with printf string as a search pattern, so that it will not be required to open the file to search for the string.

At the prompt, type in the following:

```
$ vi +/printf xyz.c
```

On hitting *Enter*, the cursor will be placed at the start of the line where the pattern is found. Also, if you are searching for any special characters, such as "[, *", it needs to be escaped with "\".

—Ronak, ronak.vashi@gmail.com



Figure out your processor's speed

Here is a simple command to check your CPU speed:

```
awk -F": " '{cpu MHz}' / { print "Processor (or core) running speed is: " $2 }' /proc/cpuinfo
```

—Amol Takkalki, takkalki.amol@gmail.com

END

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